ELLEVATION

Illinois state buyer's guide



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State and federal education funding provides a critical opportunity for districts to invest in high-impact tools that support EL programs. Ellevation is an allowable purchase under some state funding streams, including those dedicated to multilingual learner programs, professional development, and data-driven instructional support.

This guide outlines key state and federal funding sources and how they can be used to purchase Ellevation for your district to equip educators with research-based strategies, streamline compliance and reporting, and enhance student outcomes.

Disclaimer: The information provided in this first section is specific to funding provided by the state of Illinois. If your district is not in Illinois, please see Title Funds Buyer's Guide.

Illinois state funding sources

Local Funds

Most districts allocate annual funds sourced from local governments through their budgets to ensure educational technology investments are sustained over time and implemented with fidelity. Common budget line categorizations for Edtech investments include instructional technology or curriculum and instruction. Many districts fund the use of Ellevation through local funds.

Illinois Evidence-Based Funding (EBF)

The EBF funding provided to districts in Illinois includes the general funding levels and additional funding to support specific student populations. Districts must complete an EBF Spending Plan and describe their use of funds within the list of the 34 cost factors used to determine funding amounts for each district.

One cost factor is "Professional Development" and is described in the EBF Spending Plan Guidance as "training programs for licensed staff in schools, including, but not limited to, programs that assist in implementing new curriculum programs, provide data focused or academic assessment data training to help staff identify a student's weaknesses and strengths, target interventions, improve instruction, encompass instructional strategies for English learner, gifted, or at-risk students, address inclusivity, cultural sensitivity, or implicit bias, or otherwise provide professional support for licensed staff."

Districts in Illinois have used EBF funding to purchase Ellevation products by determining that, based on the description in the previous paragraph, it is allowable because Strategies is a training program for licensed staff that includes data focused training to help staff identify a student's weaknesses and strengths, which can be done using Platform, and improve instruction using instructional strategies for English learner students found in Strategies.

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Federal title funding sources

Our solutions support the growing needs of more than 2.5 million multilingual learners. Districts across the nation use Title I, II, III, and IV funds to drive effective English learner (EL) instructional practices and develop higher levels of student achievement. Most EL teams that invest in Ellevation use **Title III funds**. You can learn more about common funding options below, and know that you can count on us to help find the right fit for your EL program.

Title I

The purpose of Title I is "to provide all children significant opportunity to receive a fair, equitable, and high-quality education, and to close educational achievement gaps" (ESSA Sec. 1001). Title I is also responsible for ensuring state and district accountability for EL student language proficiency and academic achievement. See more information on laws and guidance here.

Ellevation supports Title I activities in the following ways:

Sec. 1001, Sec. 1003(b), Sec. 1111(c)(4)(B), Sec. 1112(b)

- Meeting the educational needs of specific groups of students, including EL students
- Meeting accountability goals and targets for EL student language proficiency, academic achievement, and academic growth
- Supporting local education agencies (LEAs) with schools identified for Support and Improvement because their ELs aren't meeting accountability goals and targets
- Closing the achievement gap between low and high-performing children
- Supporting collaboration and integration of Title I services with other programs and services supporting ELs

Ellevation aids LEAs and schools in supporting English learners, providing teacher strategies, and closing the achievement gap.

Ellevation helps LEAs and schools meet the specific needs of English learners, identify where EL students need additional support, provide teachers with activities and strategies to serve EL students, and close the achievement gap between ELs and their English-speaking peers in many ways:

- **Ellevation Platform** provides all educators in the LEA access to EL student data, including multiple sets of assessment and instructional data needed to make important learning decisions. Teachers are able to set and monitor goals for their EL students and can easily identify where students are excelling and where students need additional support.
- **Ellevation Strategies** provides educators of all grade-levels and subject areas activities and strategies that support differentiated instruction and engagement of all students. The activities and strategies use sound pedagogical practices targeted at supporting language development while enabling access to content. Ellevation Strategies is tied to all student data in the Ellevation Platform and guides educators to select activities and strategies that will address the specific needs of the students in their classroom.

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Ellevation helps schools in implementing Title I programs and improvement plans and offering flexibility to enhance student performance.

Sec.1003(e)(1)(F), 1111(c)(4), Sec. 1111(d), Sec. 1114, Sec. 1115, Sec 1003(f)

Distributing and targeting resources sufficiently to make a difference to schools implementing Title I Schoolwide or Targeted Assistance programs and implementing plans related to schools identified for support and improvement where needs are greatest *(Sec 1003(f))*; Providing greater flexibility to LEAs, schools and teachers in effectively implementing activities to improve student performance.

- **Ellevation Platform** provides greater operational flexibility to LEAs and schools, allowing them to fully and effectively implement the EL services identified as part of Title I Schoolwide Program Plans, Title I Targeted Assistance Program Plans, and School Support and Improvement plans. Ellevation compiles all student data in one place and enables district administrators to view, analyze, and track important EL program metrics such as language proficiency, academic achievement, academic growth, and compliance activity completion (annual parent letters, student progress monitoring, headcount, etc). Administrators can create and save various data views and dashboards to have easy access to the data needed to make informed decisions about resources, instruction, and more. This platform enables administrators to use the data to distribute and target resources where the needs are greatest in order to make the biggest impact.
- **Ellevation Strategies** provides educators of all grade-levels and subject areas activities and strategies to use in the classroom with any content or curriculum that supports differentiated instruction and engagement of all students. The activities and strategies use sound pedagogical practices targeted at supporting language development while enabling access to the content being taught. Additionally, educators can access professional development (PD) tools to support their growing understanding of English learning best practices that they can implement in their classrooms right away.

Ellevation supports the coordinating and integrating of Title I services with other educational services at the LEA and school level, including services for EL students.

Sec. 1112(c)(4), EDGAR 34 CFR 200.77(f)

- Both **Ellevation Platform** and **Strategies** are available to all administrators and educators throughout the LEA regardless of which ESSA program they may be implementing, as well as general education staff, to ensure that everyone in the district has access to important student information, strategies, and instruction for students. This widespread access supports the coordination of services across the district and with other agencies providing services to English learners.
- In addition, education regulations indicate that it is allowable for districts to reserve Title I funds for district use to provide coordinated services like **Ellevation Platform** and **Strategies** across educational programs.

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Important Title I considerations

As you determine whether or not you will use Title I to purchase Ellevation, please keep the following considerations in mind:

- Because Title I is used both at the LEA-level and the school-level, Title I funding is frequently used for school-level purchases. However, because education regulations allow districts to reserve funds at the district level for collaboration requirements for EL programs and for school support and improvement, and given that accountability for EL students language proficiency and academic achievement are indicators used to identify schools for support and improvement under Title I, an LEA-level purchase with Title I funds is both allowable and advisable. This ensures access to the LEA's purchase of Ellevation for all educators in the LEA that need it.
- Based on the Title III Supplement not Supplant provision, once an LEA uses a funding source other than Title III to purchase Ellevation, future use of Title III is typically not allowed. If a buyer believes they will want to use Title III funds in future years, it is best to use those funds in the first year. Please see question A-2 in the ESSA guidance document related to English learners and Title III for more information about the Title III Supplement not Supplant provision.

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Title II

The purpose of Title II is to provide resources to local education agencies (LEAs) to increase student achievement consistent with state standards, improve the quality and effectiveness of teachers and leaders, increase the number of teachers and leaders who are effective in improving student achievement, and provide low-income and minority students greater access to effective teachers and leaders. See more information on laws and guidance here.

Ellevation supports Title II activities in the following ways:

Sec. 2102(b)(2)(D), Sec. 2103(b)(3)(E)

Providing high-quality, personalized professional development that is evidence-based for teachers, instructional leadership teams, principals, or other school leaders, that is focused on improving teacher and student learning and achievement, including supporting efforts to train teachers, principals or other school leaders to effectively integrate technology into curricula and instruction, use data to improve student achievement, and help all students develop the skills essential to learning readiness and academic success.

- **Ellevation Strategies** empowers educators with evidence-based instructional techniques to help ELs acquire language and master grade level content. Teachers participate in learning modules that steward them through interactive professional learning (PL) experiences that build knowledge and capacity to serve ELs. Strategies also includes a bank of over 100 activities that can be easily embedded into any lesson, regardless of grade level and subject. These high-quality, engaging activities support all models of language instruction and support educators in teaching language and content simultaneously. All of the resources within Strategies tie directly to student data loaded into the Ellevation Platform so that educators can easily provide students supports that meet them at their current level.
- **Ellevation Platform** includes EL student data and analytical tools to increase the ability of teachers and leaders to focus instruction on improving teaching, student learning, and academic achievement of EL students. Ellevation Platform provides teachers and leaders with EL data analysis that can be used to identify and select instructional services. When used with Ellevation Strategies' professional learning modules, it helps increase the ability of teachers and leaders to improve teaching, student learning, and achievement for ELs.

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Ellevation aids in developing programs and activities that increase the ability of teachers to effectively teach English learners so that they can meet the challenging State academic standards.

Sec. 2103(b)(3)(F)

- **Ellevation Strategies** helps educators learn and apply evidence-based instructional techniques to help ELs acquire language and master grade level content. Our innovative product supports job-embedded professional learning for every educator in the district through interactive learning modules that teach educators the “why” behind EL instructional practices and prepares them to apply their learning in their classrooms. All educators have access to over 100 activities that can easily be included in their lesson plans, regardless of subject area or grade-level. All of the resources within Strategies tie directly to student data loaded into the Ellevation Platform so that educators can easily provide students supports that meet them at their current level.
- **Ellevation Platform** gives educators tools they can use to increase the ability of teachers to effectively teach ELs by providing EL data and analysis tools which help them identify and select instructional services and professional learning modules that increase the ability of teachers to effectively implement those instructional services in the classroom.

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Title III

The purpose of this federal program is to ensure that English learners (ELs) and immigrant students attain English proficiency and develop high levels of academic achievement in English Sec. 3102(1&2). An additional purpose of the Title III is to assist teachers, principals and other school leaders, and local educational agencies to develop and enhance their capacity to provide effective instructional programs designed to prepare English learners, including immigrant children and youth, to enter all-English instructional settings Sec. 3102(4). See more information on laws and guidance here.

Ellevation supports Title III activities in the following ways:

Sec. 3102(1&2), Sec. 3102(4), Sec. 3115(c)(2)

Ellevation provides tools to classroom teachers and leaders that are effective in helping teachers and leaders improve instruction and assessment of ELs, enhance the ability of teachers and leaders to understand and implement instructional strategies, increasing teaching knowledge, and teaching skills, and is of sufficient intensity and duration to have a positive and lasting impact on teacher performance, Sec. 3115(c)(2).

- **Ellevation Strategies** provides professional development modules to teachers and leaders that can be incorporated into professional learning plans to enable educators to better meet the needs of EL students in a positive and long-lasting way. It also provides all classroom teachers with job-imbedded professional development with best-practice instructional activities that can be easily incorporated into any lesson regardless of subject, grade level, topic or standard. All of the strategies and activities in Ellevation are designed to help teachers and leaders improve instruction and assessment of ELs to enhance their abilities to understand and implement instructional strategies, increase teaching knowledge and teaching skills, and are of sufficient intensity and duration to have a positive and lasting impact on teacher performance.

Ellevation upgrades program objectives and effective instructional strategies.

Sec. 3115(d)(1)

- Ellevation helps ensure that ELs and immigrant students attain English proficiency and develop high levels of achievement by providing educators with effective instructional strategies to use in their classroom. By combining these strategies with student data, dynamic reporting, and collaboration tools, Ellevation supports districts in upgrading their English learner program objectives.
  - **Ellevation Strategies** provides all classroom teachers with best-practice instructional activities that can be easily incorporated into any lesson regardless of subject, grade level, topic or standard to effectively differentiate instruction for ELs. All of the strategies and activities in Ellevation are founded upon evidence-based best practices and provide job embedded professional development to classroom teachers.
  - **Ellevation Platform** strengthens Ellevation Strategies by combining them with student data. Educators can target their instruction as well as the activities in Ellevation Strategies by reviewing student profiles and instructional plans in the Ellevation Platform.

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Ellevation helps improve the instructional program for English learner students by identifying, acquiring, and upgrading curricula, instruction materials, educational software, and assessment procedures.

Sec. 3115(d)(2)

- Ellevation improves English learner instructional programs by supporting districts with best-in-class instructional materials, educational software, and assessment procedures.
  - **Ellevation Platform** does not replace an existing software program but, rather, helps district leaders and educators reinvent the procedures and best practices of effective EL Programs. Ellevation's monitoring and meeting center help make important program components like teacher input and student plan creation quick to complete and easy to store and access.
  - **Ellevation Strategies** empowers teachers of every subject and grade to differentiate instruction for ELs with skill and confidence while engaging all students in sound pedagogical practices. Our program builds capacity on campuses to ensure every K-12 content area teacher is a teacher of language. In addition, Ellevation Strategies supports district professional development plans and provides on-demand supports for educators.

Ellevation aids in improving the English proficiency and academic achievement of limited English proficient children.

Sec. 3115(d)(5)

- Ellevation improves the English proficiency and academic achievement of English learner students by supporting district administrators, classroom educators, and students themselves.
  - **Ellevation Platform** compiles all student data in one place and enables district administrators to view, analyze, and track student progress. Administrators can create and save student progress views and dashboards to have easy access to the data needed to set language development goals aligned to English language development standards and to make informed decisions about resources, instruction, and more.
  - **Ellevation Strategies** provides professional development strategies and activities that help all stakeholders more effectively plan and deliver instruction that supports both language development towards English proficiency and academic content mastery. The 100+ language activities work with any content area and any grade level and make the classroom content accessible for all students, regardless of their English proficiency level.

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Ellevation improves the instruction of English learners by providing best-in-class educational technology and instructional materials and enables educators across the district to participate in an electronic network for materials, training, and communication.

Sec. 3115(d)(7),

- Improving the instruction of ELs by providing for (A) the acquisition or development of educational technology or instructional materials; (B) access to, and participation in, electronic networks for materials, training, and communication; and (C) incorporation of the resources described in subparagraphs (A) and (B) into curricula and programs, such as those funded under this subpart.
  - **Ellevation Platform** provides all educators in the district access to EL student data, including multiple sets of assessment and instructional data to make important learning decisions and set and monitor goals for their EL students. Additionally, all users have the ability to document key observations and decisions directly in the platform, ensuring effective communication between all of a student's educators.
  - **Ellevation Strategies** provides educators of all grade-levels and subject areas activities and strategies that support differentiated instruction and engagement of all students. The activities and strategies use sound pedagogical practices targeted at supporting language development while enabling access to content.

Ellevation also helps carry out other activities that are consistent with the purposes of Title III Sec. 3115(d)(9). See the introduction to this section for the purposes of Title III as outlined in Sec. 3102(1-4).

- Ellevation includes activities that help educators help EL students attain English proficiency and develop high levels of academic achievement.
  - **Ellevation Platform** provides the tools and resources teachers, principals, and other school leaders need to enable English learner students to attain English proficiency and develop high levels of academic achievement in English, to assist all English learner students to achieve at high levels in academic subjects so that all English learner students can meet the same challenging State academic standards that all children are expected to meet.
  - **Ellevation Strategies** assists teachers, principals, and other schools leaders, local education agencies, and schools in establishing, implementing, and sustaining effective language instruction educational programs designed to assist in teaching English learner students; and assists teachers, principals, and other schools leaders, and local education agencies to develop and enhance their capacity to provide effective instructional programs designed to prepare English learner students to enter all-English instructional settings.

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Important Title III considerations

As you determine whether or not you will use Title III to purchase Ellevation, please keep the following considerations in mind:

- If you plan to use Title III funds in the future to support your Ellevation commitment, it is important that you use Title III funds at the start of your engagement with Ellevation. This is because the Title III Supplement not Supplant provision indicates that once an LEA uses a funding source other than Title III to purchase Ellevation, future use of Title III is typically not allowed. If a buyer believes they will want to use Title III funds in future years, it is best to use those funds in the first year. Please see question A-2 in the ESSA guidance document related to English learners and Title III for more information about the Title III Supplement not Supplant provision. Please inquire with your Ellevation representative if you have questions about your funding sources.
- Ellevation does not replace existing systems, nor does it take the place of processes that should be the core responsibility of a district. A purchase of Ellevation does not violate the Title III supplement not supplant provisions because Ellevation's products support the purposes of Title III (Sec. 3115(d)(9) and Sec. 3102(1-4)). While some features of Ellevation may reflect those that are the core responsibility of an LEA, the purpose of Ellevation is to provide supplemental resources. The use of Ellevation to enhance the core responsibilities of an LEA should be considered an incidental benefit that adds no additional expense and not a motivational reason to purchase Ellevation with federal funds. Ellevation supplements existing processes and data systems to drive greater insights into student performance, efficiency, and needs. The tools enhance EL instruction by providing an additional layer of support – on top of the requirements set forth by Lau v. Nichols. In this respect, Ellevation supplements, but does not supplant, the work of EL programs.

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Title IV, Part A

The purpose of this federal program is to improve students' academic achievement by increasing the capacity of States, LEAs, schools, and local communities to provide all students with access to a well-rounded education, improve school conditions for student learning, and improve the use of technology in order to improve the academic achievement and digital literacy of all students. See more information on laws and guidance here.

Ellevation supports Title IV, Part A activities in the following ways:

Sec. 4107(a)(3)(C)(i), Sec. 4109(a)(1)(A-D), Sec. 4109(a)(2)(B)

Providing students with a well-rounded education including programs to improve instruction and student engagement in science, technology, engineering and mathematics, including increasing access for students through grade 12 who are members of underrepresented groups such as English learners.

- Ellevation helps districts provide students with a well-rounded education by improving instruction and engagement in all content areas. Ellevation's instructional tools use best-practices in English language development to enable students to prepare for classroom instruction and have access to grade-level rigorous content.
  - **Ellevation Strategies** empowers teachers of every subject and grade to differentiate instruction for ELs with skill and confidence while engaging all students in sound pedagogical practices. Our program will build capacity on campuses to ensure every K-12 content area teacher is a teacher of language. In addition, Strategies supports district professional development plans and provides on-demand supports for educators.
  - **Ellevation Platform** provides all educators in the district access to EL student data, including multiple sets of assessment and instructional data to make important learning decisions which help increase access to instruction and student engagement in science, technology, engineering and mathematics for EL students who are members of an underrepresented groups.

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Ellevation supports the effective use of technology in schools with PL tools, resources, and training to personalize learning and improve student outcomes.

Sec. 4109(a)(1)(A-D), Sec. 4109(a)(2)(B)

Supporting the effective use of technology that includes providing educators, school leaders, and administrators with the professional learning tools, devices, content, and resources to personalize learning to improve student outcomes, discover, adapt, and share relevant high-quality educational resources, use technology effectively in the classroom by administering computer-based assessments and blended learning strategies, and implement and support school- and district-wide approaches for using technology to inform instruction, support teacher collaboration, and personalize learning - Sec. 4109(a)(1)(A-D); and supporting the effective use of technology that includes building technological capacity and infrastructure by purchasing software applications in order to address readiness shortfalls; Sec. 4109(a)(2)(B).

- Ellevation supports the effective use of technology that provides educators, school leaders, and administrators with the professional learning tools and resources to personalize learning to improve student outcomes.
- Ellevation also supports the effective use of technology to address readiness shortfalls in EL students by providing software applications to educators, school leaders, and administrators that help identify the reasons for any readiness shortfalls and provide data analysis and professional learning modules and activities to address these shortfalls.
    - **Ellevation Platform** provides all educators in the district access to EL student data, including multiple sets of assessment and instructional data to make important learning decisions and set and monitor goals for their EL students. The Ellevation Platform enables effective communication across the district by providing student data as well as collaboration tools such as teacher input forms and notes to all educators, school leaders, and administrators.
    - **Ellevation Strategies** provides educators of all grade-levels and subject areas activities and strategies that support differentiated instruction and engagement of all students. The activities and strategies use sound pedagogical practices targeted at supporting language development while enabling access to content.

Important Title IV, Part A considerations

As you determine whether or not you will use Title IV, Part A funds to purchase Ellevation, please keep the following considerations in mind:

ESSA includes spending limits on each category of activities: 20% on well-rounded education, 20% on health and safety, and 60% on improving technology use.

If you have questions about state-specific funding options, please contact sales@ellevationeducation.com.

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